

305 BCE FOUNDING OF THE PTOLEMAIC DYNASTY

A former bodyguard and companion of Alexander the Great, Ptolemy was appointed governor of Egypt after Alexander's death in 323 BCE, and in 305 BCE assumed the title of pharaoh. As Ptolemy I he founded the Ptolemaic dynasty, ruling Egypt as a Hellenistic kingdom. He was also a writer and historian, and was instrumental in making his capital, Alexandria, a centre of Greek culture.

▷ **Ptolemy I** inaugurating the Library at Alexandria



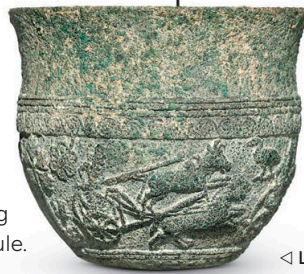
332 BCE Alexander conquers Egypt, extending his empire southwards until it reaches the Kingdom of Kush

c. 330 BCE Euclid of Alexandria, author of the mathematical treatise *Elements*, is born

301 BCE

321–185 BCE THE MAURYA EMPIRE

Chandragupta Maurya established the Maurya Empire by replacing the Nanda dynasty in northern India. When Greek forces began to withdraw from the farther reaches of Alexander the Great's empire after his death, Chandragupta seized the opportunity to invade, bringing all of the north of the subcontinent under Maurya rule.



◁ Libation cup, Maurya dynasty

c. 400–51 BCE THE ROMAN– GALLIC WARS



As Celts began to migrate from the northern Alps to settle in the Po valley in Italy, they triggered a long series of conflicts with Rome.

387 BCE Brennus of the Senones leads Celts in the sacking of the city of Rome; according to legend, geese raise the alarm (*above*).



298–290 BCE An alliance of Samnites (*helmet above*), Gauls, and others engages with Rome for control of central and southern Italy.



125–121 BCE Roman forces defeat the Gauls of the Arverni tribe (*coin above*), claiming their territory as a Roman province.



58–51 BCE Julius Caesar conducts a major military campaign in his determination to conquer the whole of Gaul.